BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

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US Networking & Communications Equipment

Corning Inc

Rating

Market-Perform

Price Target

GLW **140.00 USD**

Quick Take: GLW Q3 26 earnings beat but soft guidance for Q4

GLW reported their Q3 26 results this Tuesday, October 27th, before the open.

Corning Q3 26 revenue of $5.1B beat us and consensus at $5.0B. Their reported EPS of $0.91 also beat consensus at $0.88 and us at $0.81. However, free cash flow was slightly light at $661M, compared to consensus at $867M and us at $864M.

The beat was largely driven by Optical Communications, which beat at $2.4B while Glass Innovations revenue was in line at $1.5B. Corning reported Optical Communications revenue of $2.4B, beating/missing consensus at $2.22B and our estimates at $2.18B. Glass Innovations was at $1.51B, down from consensus at $1.52B and our estimates at $1.53B. Automotive revenue at $470M missed consensus at $464M and our estimates at $468M. Solar revenue was at $436M, below consensus at $501M and us at $479M, and Life Sciences & Emerging Growth revenue at $290M, below consensus at $294M and us at $296M.

For next quarter, Corning guided to $5.2-5.3B in total revenue and $0.96-1.00 in EPS. $5.2-5.3B in revenue is slightly light compared to our estimate of $5.4, but still on track to hit their guided $20B 2026 revenue run rate. EPS of $0.96-$1.00 is above our estimate of $0.90. Corning did not update its longer term growth framework, or give incremental detail for 2027.

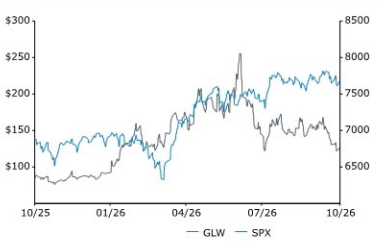
Going into the call, our focus is on incremental commentary on scale-up. We also want to see how Corning expects to navigate slowing end markets growth, as well as incremental detail about capacity growth for Corning and its peers. We would also like more clarity on apparent margin strength and revenue softness into the fourth quarter.

Close Date	26 Oct 2026
GLW Close Price (USD)	127.74
Price Target (USD)	140.00
Upside/(Downside)	10%
52-Week Range	271.78/77.39
SPX	7,676.77
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	0.9%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	110,034
EV (USD) (M)	117,476

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	45.9	(18.5)	(24.0)	42.9
SPX (%)	12.1	(0.9)	7.1	13.0
Relative (%)	33.7	(17.6)	(31.1)	29.9

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Investment Implications

We maintain our Market Perform rating and our price target of $140.

Reported EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
GLW (USD)	2.54	3.19	4.14

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Revenues (M)	16,408	19,433	22,776	17.8%
EBITDA (M)	4,507	5,602	6,733	22.2%
Net Income Margin (%)	10.6	7.2	12.8	--

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Reported P/E (x)	50.4	40.0	30.9
Adjusted P/E (x)	50.4	40.0	30.9
EV/Sales (x)	7.2	6.0	5.2
EV/EBITDA (x)	26.1	21.0	17.4

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

See the Disclosure Appendix of this report for required disclosures, analyst certifications and other important information. Alternatively, visit our Global Research Disclosure Website.
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DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: **GLW Guidance vs Results by Quarter**

GLW Guidance Tracker		Guidance Low	Guidance Mid	Guidance High	Bernstein Estimates	Consensus Estimates	Actual
3Q26	Revenue ($B)	4.90	4.95	5.00	4.95	5.02	5.08
	EPS ($)	0.85	0.87	0.89	0.81	0.88	0.91
4Q26E	Revenue ($B)	5.20	5.25	5.30	5.40	5.20	
	EPS ($)	0.96	0.98	1.00	0.90	0.93	

Source: Bloomberg (as of 10/26/26), Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **GLW Q3 26: Bernstein and Consensus Estimates vs Reported Results**

GLW Reported Results vs. Bernstein / Consensus (FY26 Q3)						
Revenue ($M)	**Bernstein**	**Reported**	**Delta**	**Consensus**	**Reported**	**Delta**
Optical Communications	2,183	2,379	9%	2,224	2,379	7%
Glass Innovations	1,529	1,506	-1%	1,520	1,506	-1%
Automotive	468	470	1%	464	470	1%
Solar	479	436	-9%	501	436	-13%
Life Sciences & Emerging Growth Businesses	296	290	-2%	294	290	-1%
Total Revenue	**4,954**	4,855	-2%	**5,019**	4,855	-3%
EPS ($)	**0.81**	0.91	12%	**0.88**	0.91	3%
FCF ($M)	**867**	661	-24%	**864**	661	-24%

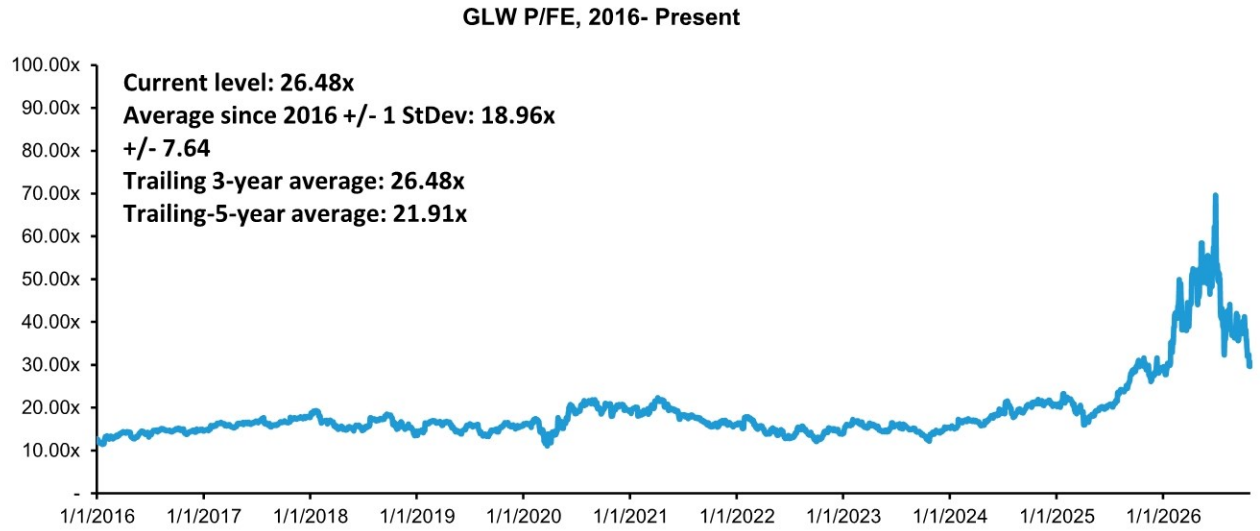
Source: Company filings, Bloomberg (consensus as of 10/26/26), Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **Corning Bernstein vs. Consensus**

GLW	FY27E	FY28E	FY29E	FY30E
Total Revenue ($M)				
Consensus	$23,059	$27,944	$33,268	$39,420
Actual / Bernstein Est.	**$22,776**	**$28,000**	**$33,653**	**$39,367**
Bernstein vs. Cons.	*-1.2%*	*0.2%*	*1.2%*	*-0.1%*
EPS ($)				
Consensus	$4.38	$5.93	$7.19	$9.09
Actual / Bernstein Est.	**$4.14**	**$5.62**	**$7.29**	**$9.07**
Bernstein vs. Cons.	*-5.5%*	*-5.1%*	*1.4%*	*-0.2%*
Operating Profit ($M)				
Consensus	$5,408	$7,170	$8,289	$10,289
Actual / Bernstein Est.	**$5,118**	**$6,795**	**$8,694**	**$10,741**
Bernstein vs. Cons.	*-5.4%*	*-5.2%*	*4.9%*	*4.4%*
Optical Communications				
Revenue Consensus	$11,605	$15,859	$19,699	$24,654
vs. Bernstein	**$11,363**	**$15,909**	**$20,948**	**$26,238**
Profit Margins Consensus	21.69%	22.39%	23.25%	24.25%
vs. Bernstein	**21.75%**	**22.75%**	**23.75%**	**24.75%**
Glass Innovations				
Revenue Consensus	$6,012	$6,153	$6,358	$6,520
vs. Bernstein	**$6,073**	**$6,316**	**$6,568**	**$6,765**
Profit Margins Consensus	22.96%	23.16%	23.38%	23.38%
vs. Bernstein	**23.25%**	**23.25%**	**23.25%**	**23.25%**
Automotive				
Revenue Consensus	$1,893	$1,964	$2,055	$2,114
vs. Bernstein	**$1,920**	**$2,016**	**$2,117**	**$2,202**
Profit Margins Consensus	17.11%	17.30%	16.75%	16.75%
vs. Bernstein	**15.86%**	**15.86%**	**15.86%**	**15.86%**
Solar				
Revenue Consensus	$2,445	$2,844	$3,195	$3,470
vs. Bernstein	**$2,261**	**$2,600**	**$2,860**	**$3,004**
Profit Margins Consensus	7.68%	10.03%	12.00%	12.67%
vs. Bernstein	**5.00%**	**8.00%**	**10.00%**	**12.00%**
Life Sciences and Emerging Growth				
Revenue Consensus	$1,186	$1,207	$1,216	$1,236
vs. Bernstein	**$1,159**	**$1,159**	**$1,159**	**$1,159**
Profit Margins Consensus	-5.19%	-4.51%	-7.50%	-4.33%
vs. Bernstein	**-4.00%**	**-2.00%**	**0.00%**	**2.00%**

Source: Bloomberg (updated 10/26/26 at close), Bernstein estimates and analysis

EXHIBIT 4: **GLW P/FE Chart, 2016-now**



Source: Bloomberg (updated 10/26/26), Bernstein estimates and analysis

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			26 Oct 2026		TTM		Reported EPS			Reported P/E (x)		
			Closing	Price	Rel.							
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
GLW (Corning)	M	USD	127.74	140.00	29.9%	USD	2.54	3.19	4.14	50.4	40.0	30.9
SPX			7,676.77									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Corning Inc

We apply a ~25x multiple to our estimate of $5.7 in FY 28 EPS, and set our price target at $140.

RISKS

Corning Inc

Our price target for Corning could see upside if Optical adoption accelerates as CPO yield improves, driving upside to 2027-2028 numbers

Our price target for Corning could see upside if Reacceleration in the smartphone or autos markets supports a stronger growth outlook for Corning

Our price target for Corning could see downside if AI adoption decelerates, in turn leading to reduced investment in AI infrastructure

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION

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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

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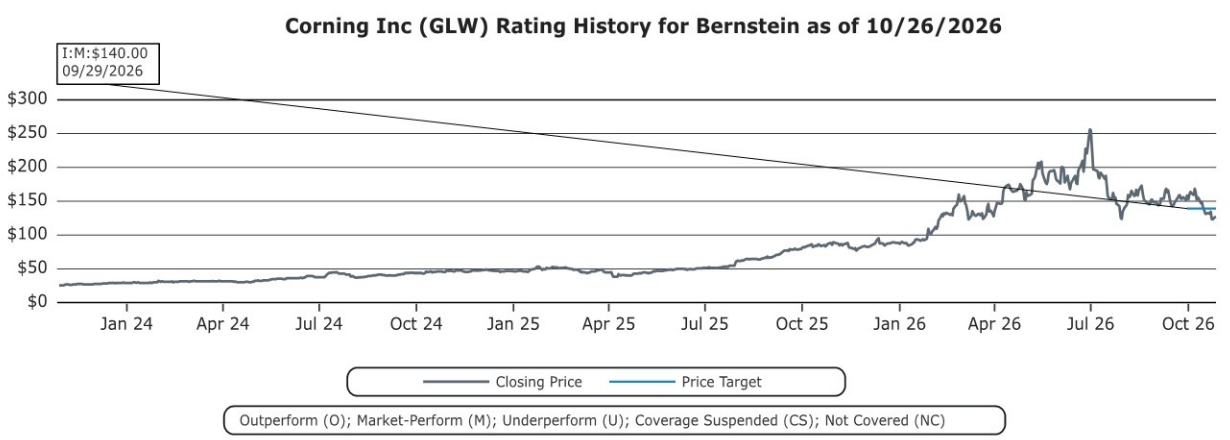
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Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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